Aesthetic Infection Control

Cosmetic Courses

Aesthetics AWARDS Winner 2025

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Agenda

- What is infection control
- Types of infection
- Basic principles
- Prevention
- Aseptic techniques
- Products
- Support

What is infection control?

Preventing or stopping the spread of infections

When you consider the time, money and productivity lost during sickness and managing complications, it is important for everyone to consider the impact of infection prevention within the workplace and their day to day lives.

Types of Infection

Viral – Viruses form part of a cell and are made of protein. When these particles are released they then infect more cells causing the spread. They cannot survive for long outside of the host cell and can attack many parts of the body. They include the common cold and flu

Bacterial – single cell organisms which can live on their own in or around the body. Some are good (such as for gut health) or an overgrowth can make you ill. Bacteria can be contracted directly or indirectly through surfaces or infected skin

Fungal – multi celled, which can live on or around the body. Usually won't cause harm unless an individual has a weakened or compromised immune system. Fungi can cause skin diseases or infect the lungs/nervous system

Parasitic – caused by parasites which thrive in moisture. Generally spread through water but can also be contracted from bites or feces

Transfer

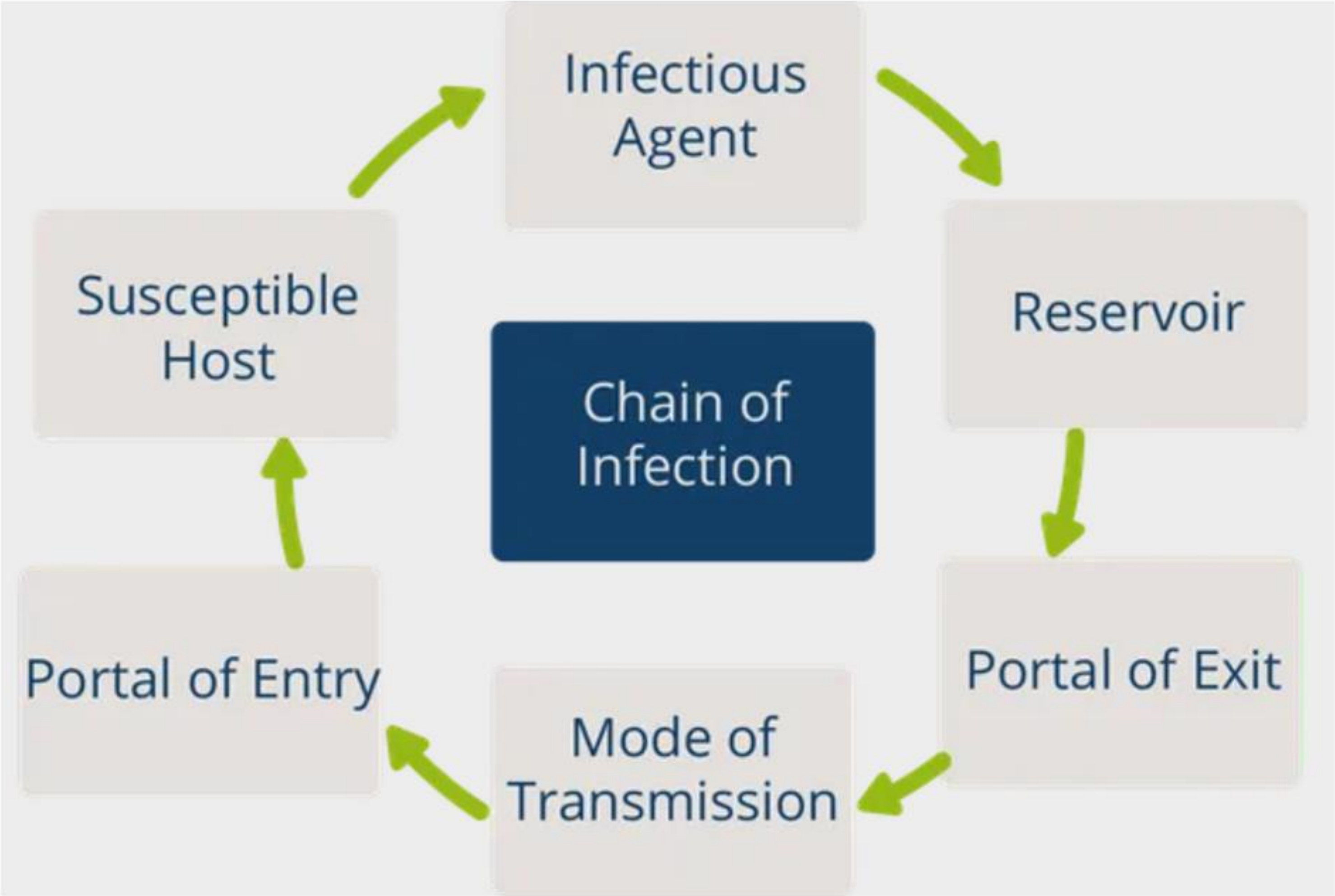
Micro organisms (bacteria and viruses) can multiply and spread in certain conditions. This is based on the temperature, moisture, nutrients and time it is present

They can be passed **directly** (person to person contact) or **indirectly** (air, contaminated objects or blood) via bodily fluids and poor hygiene

Infection can pass into the body through tracts (respiratory, digestive, urinary, reproductive) as well as through open wounds in the skin

Poor hygiene, lack of cleaning, missing or unsuitable PPE and contaminated tools can all contribute to the spread

Chain of Infection - series of actions which enable bacteria, fungi or virus to spread



https://openwho.org/courses/IPC-INTRO-EN

The chain can be broken at any of these actions

Standard Infection Control Measures

Standard Infection Control Precautions (SICPs)

- Assessment of risk of infection
- Hand hygiene
- Respiratory and cough
- Personal protective equipment
- Safe management of the environment
- Safe management of equipment
- Safe management of consumables/linen
- Safe management of blood and body fluids

Adherence to Guidelines

As a practitioner it is important to maintain your duty of care to your patients and abide by all governmental, local authority and clinic protocols.

Failure to do so could result in harm to yourself or those around you as well as a breach of your professional code of conduct

Infection Control in Aesthetics

Aesthetic treatments also require a high level of infection control in order to minimise the risk of the spread of infection

Infections can occur when bacteria are introduced during the treatment or spread to the entry site from other areas which are contaminated

Infection can not only present itself quickly but can also be asymptomatic and present later on as tender, red, nodules sometimes accompanied by an abscess. Leading to further complications to manage

Causes of Infection

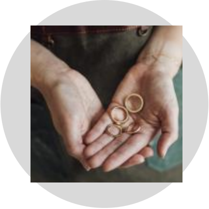
- Contaminated equipment
- Infected sources
- Poor hand hygiene
- Incorrect or lack of appropriate waste management
- Needlestick injuries

Personal Hygiene

Scrubs/uniform – must be clean and worn only within the clinical environment

Hair must be away from the face and tied back if able

Finger nails must be short and clean



Avoid jewellery on the hands/wrists and none that are dangling or could interfere with treatment

A surgical mask may be appropriate for treating close to the patient’s face or particularly if the practitioner or patient is displaying any signs of an illness

Hand hygiene and appropriate use/disposal of PPE

Respiratory Hygiene and Cough Etiquette

Practicing good respiratory and cough hygiene can limit the spread of infection.

Covering your nose and mouth or coughing/sneezing into your elbow can reduce the spread

Regular and good hand washing/sanitising will also help to reduce infection

Surfaces and Sink Disinfecting

In addition to personal hygiene it is important that sinks and surfaces are thoroughly cleaned and disinfected to reduce the risk of infection

Appropriate Skin Cleansing

Remove make up with an appropriate make up remover or cleanser *(for dermal filler treatments the full face of make up must be removed)*

Repeat until the gauze or cloth is clean with no traces of product

Wipe the area with antimicrobial skin cleanse

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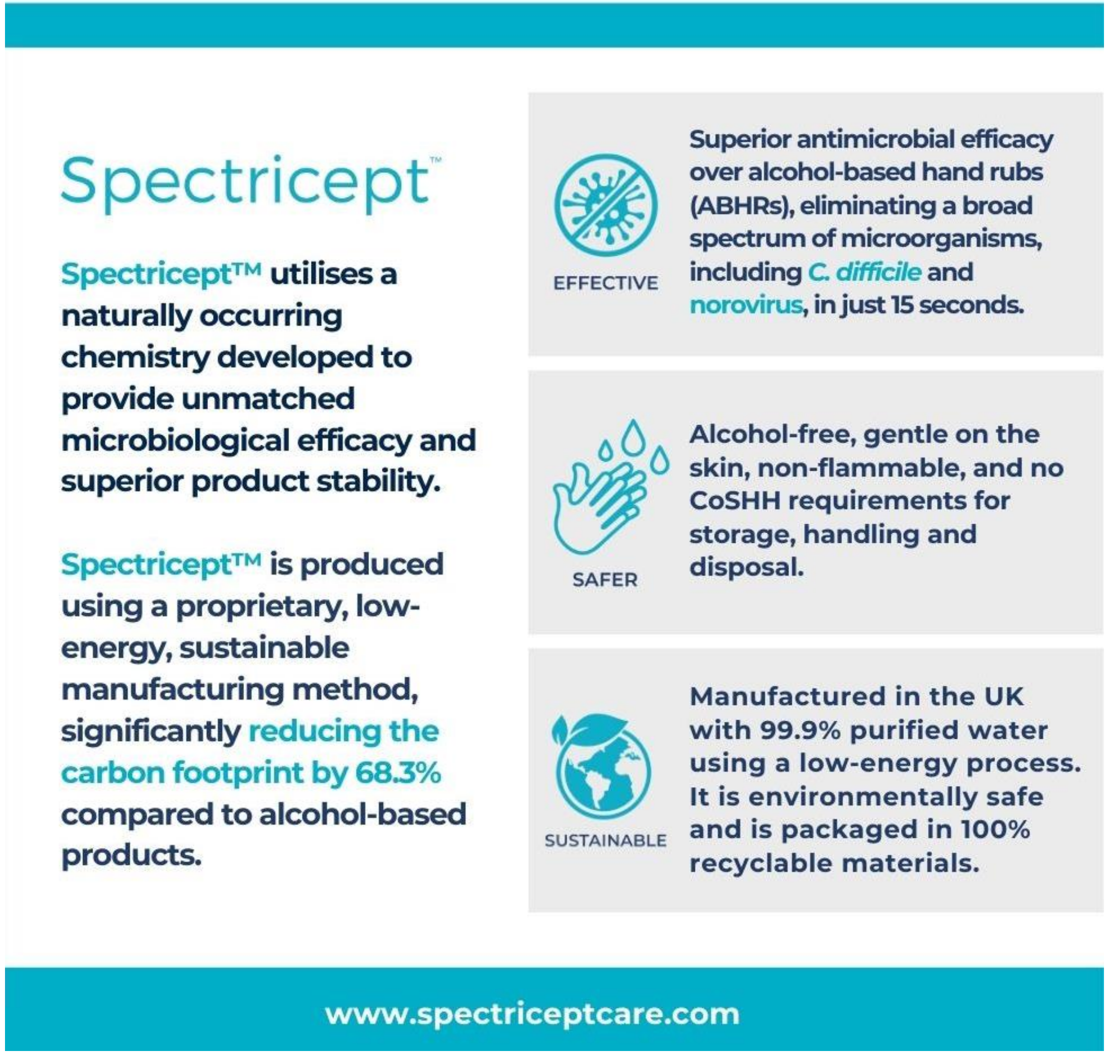


Product Comparison

Feature	Spectricept™	Alcohol Based
Kills *C. difficile* in 15 Seconds	✓	–
EN 17126 Sporicidal	✓	–
Kills Non-Enveloped Viruses (eg. norovirus)	✓	–
Alcohol-Free	✓	–
Non-Irritant	✓	–
Hazardous for Ingestion	–	⚠
Sustainable UK Manufacturing	✓	–
Non-Flammable	✓	🔥
Halal Certified	✓	–

Key Features

- Sporicidal
- Fully Virucidal
- Bactericidal
- Mycobactericidal
- Yeasticidal
- Fungicidal

Definitions

Clean – free from visible marks

Sterile – free from microorganisms

Aseptic – free from pathogens

Clean Procedure Protocol

- Wash hands
- Apply non sterile gloves
- Cleanse areas to be treated and surrounding areas which could cause contamination
- Mark up and prepare the skin
- Cleanse the skin
- Prepare sterile field/area
- Wash/sanitise hands
- Apply sterile gloves
- Perform aseptic (no touch technique)

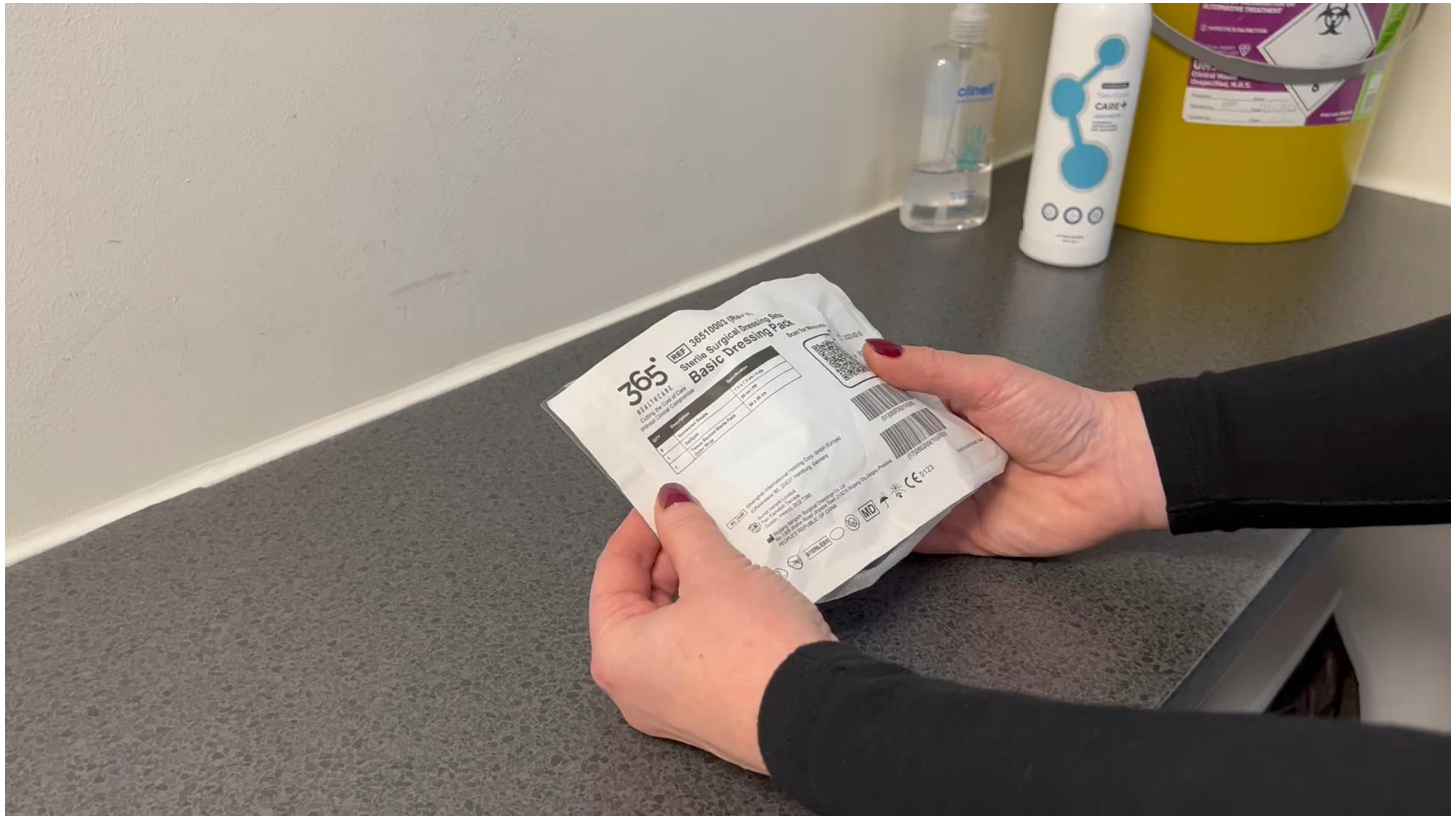
Aseptic Techniques

Aseptic techniques are common practice in healthcare settings designed to prevent the spread of infection

- Perform appropriate hand hygiene
- Ensure the area to be treated and surrounding area is thoroughly cleansed and disinfected
- Maintain a sterile field and equipment
- Needles, syringes and cannula are sterile, single use devices and should be disposed of after each treatment
- Apply and safely remove sterile gloves and personal protective equipment.
- Dispose of contaminated wastes appropriately.

Sterile Field

Contamination free area, designed to help to reduce the spread of bacteria



Using Sterile Gloves

Should be used when aseptic technique is required.

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Key Part – No Touch Technique

'Key parts' of an ANTT is a crucial component where parts of medical devices or the product within used during a procedure should never directly or indirectly be contaminated by touch.

- Key parts refer to any sterile part which is used during an aseptic technique – such as needle hub, syringe tip, cannula, needle, gloves or sterile dressing.
- Sterile items must not come into contact with non sterile items
- Always keep away from 'key parts'

Aseptic No Touch Techniques (ANTT)

A set of techniques which aim to reduce the spread of infection

- Thoroughly wash your hands and apply non sterile gloves
- Cleanse the patient's skin (ensure all traces of make up have been removed)
- Mark the area to be treated
- Ensure the patient is comfortable and everything you need is prepared
- Remove sterile gloves and wash/sanitise hands
- Now sterile – using items only within the sterile field (gauze, skin cleanse etc)
- Cleanse the skin and perform treatment
- Should any part of the needle/cannula touch the skin, hand or any other surface this must be removed and disposed of
- Should the sterile gloves touch any area outside of the clean space then they must be changed and appropriate skin cleanse performed
- At the end of the procedure the ANTT can finish and products/PPE correctly disposed of

Flow Chart (ANTT)

Waste Management

It is important that waste is disposed of in accordance with national/local authority guidance.
Accounts can be set up with your local council or private providers

Aesthetic waste needs to be separated into sharps and clinical waste bins (any contaminated consumable/waste product)

Sharps must not be resheathed

Hazardous and non hazardous waste need to be separated

Colour coded and labelling in line with regulation

Ensure the correct storage, removal and destruction of waste

Needlestick Injuries

Assess the risk of the patient for bloodborne pathogens (HIV, Hep B and Hep C status)

Complete an incident form

The recipient should be advised to attend the nearest NHS centre

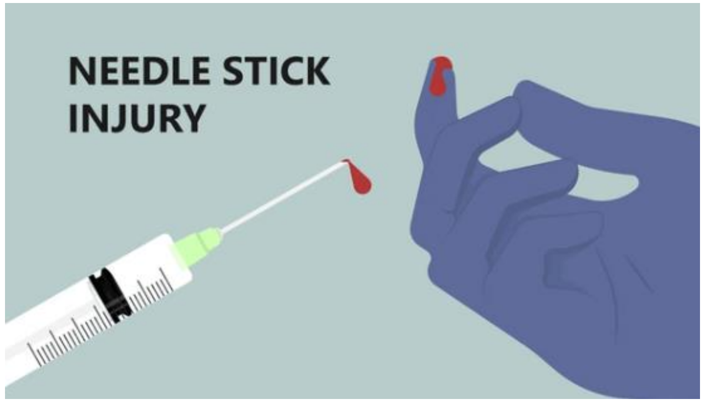
The other party can also be advised to have their bloods taken and repeated 3 months later

Where possible contact the centre to advise them of the incident and that the recipients have been advised to attend

Needlestick Wound Protocol

Immediately after:

- The wound should be encouraged to bleed under running water
- Thoroughly wash with soap and water
- Splashes to the eyes, nose or mouth should be washed thoroughly with water or preferably eye wash solution
- Cover the wound with a sterile dressing



Decontamination

Couches and seating must be impermeable to fluids with the correct cleaning protocols in place.

Any equipment which has been in contact with the patient’s skin or by contaminated materials must be appropriately cleaned or disposed of after treatment

Any pillows, blankets or covers should be avoided unless required for patient comfort/privacy. In this case the materials must be disposed of or appropriately washed after each patient (consider the possibility of contamination and how these would be avoided)

Control Measures

- ***Herpes simplex virus*** – Acyclovir could be prescribed for prophylactic control to those who suffer from cold sores
- ***Dental procedures*** pose an increased risk of infection due to the possible spread of bacteria into the tissue planes. Therefore it is advised to wait until the area has fully healed and settled before performing any aesthetic procedures particularly dermal fillers.
- ***Dermal Fillers*** require extra care with regards of infection control as the hyaluronic acid is a poly-disaccharide (a long chain of molecules joined together) composed of 2 sugar molecules which acts as a host for infection. Bacteria need energy to grow and survive. Sugar can be broken down to provide this energy and therefore creating an environment in which bacteria can thrive.
- ***Viral infections*** – it is advised to wait at least 2 weeks after recovery from a virus before performing any treatments

Certificate of Analysis (COA)

- Lab prepared document that confirms that a product meets specific quality standards.
- They ensure products performance, safety and compliance with regulations
- This is vital when choosing disinfectant and pharmaceutical products for your practice

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Consumable Sterility

- Needles, syringes and certain consumables must be sterile and sourced from reputable suppliers in order to prevent infections.

- Counterfeit products or devices may not have been through the rigorous laboratory testing or sterility processes

- Unsterile consumables can lead to a number of infections from local skin infections to bacterial infections, systemic infections and bloodborne pathogens which may be fatal.

- Sterile products must only be used once and safely disposed of. If any part of the product which touches or enters the skin becomes contaminated then this must be changed and skin disinfected before continuing.

- Unsafe practices can put both yourself and your patients at risk.

Patients with Increased Risk of Infection

- Recent illness (currently on antibiotics)
- Active sign of infection in the field to be injected (pustular acne, cold sore, impetigo)
- Type 2 diabetes (particularly where blood sugars are not well controlled)
- Recent surgery
- Recent dental procedures

Patient Aftercare and Risk Management

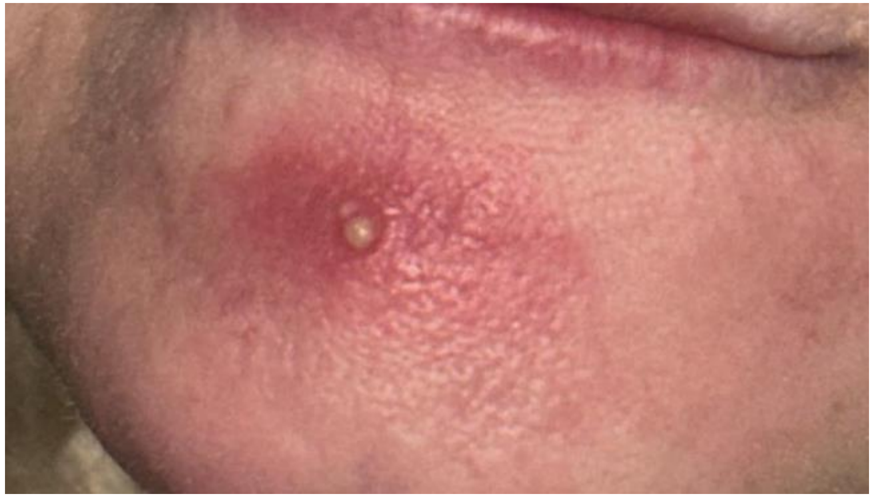
- It is vital that the patient **avoids touching the area or** wearing **make up for 24 hours** post treatment
- Follow a **clean procedure** using clinically proven products (following ANTT)
- Select your patients according to risk (ie **avoid at risk groups** such as type 2 diabetes)
- **Altering techniques** and reducing the entry sites as well as volume per site can help to minimize the risk of infection
- **Avoid counterfeit products** or consumables which have not had the rigorous testing and control measures during manufacturing as well as those which have expired.
- Attend **regular training** to stay up to date with the latest guidance and best practice protocols

- *All patients should be advised of the possible risk of infection during the consent process*

Signs of Infection

Symptoms below that do not settle within the first 48 hours after treatment or are worsening would indicate an infection

Tenderness
Heat
Erythema
Firmness
Swelling
Visible signs (pustules)



Reporting of Incidents

- Incidents should be documented and reported in an accident and incident file as well as notified to the relevant manager or responsible individual. It is good practice for these to be regularly audited and reviewed to ensure best practice and improved standards.

- Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrences Regulations (RIDDOR)
- In the UK it is law for employers, the self-employed, and those in control of any premises to report certain workplace incidents, including deaths, specified injuries, over-7-day injuries, occupational diseases, and dangerous occurrences according to the Health and Safety Executive.